Ali Demir

Economist | Applied Microeconomics

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Labor and Demographic Economics (migration, fertility and family formation).
Secondary: Urban and Regional Economics (housing).

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics *2023–2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Germany

- Dissertation: *Housing, Migration, and Family Formation*; *magna cum laude*, October 2026.
- Advisors: Thomas K. Bauer and Arnaud Chevalier.

MSc in Behavioral and Applied Economics *2021–2023*
University of Trento, Italy

- Exchange Year (Erasmus+) in Public Economics, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.
- Research Visit, Host: Susann Fiedler at Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria.

BSc in Mathematics *2016–2021*
Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey

JOB MARKET PAPER

German Internal Migration: A Marriage Market Perspective. Asks whether the young East–West migration after German reunification changed marriage formation and marital stability in receiving West German districts. Builds a new harmonized panel of 320 districts (1985–2007; back to 1982 for six states) from digitized court and vital statistics, linked to district migration matrices. Instruments cumulative young-adult arrivals with a shift-share design: 1961 census shares of residents who had come from the Soviet zone before the Berlin Wall, interacted with arrival rates in other states. Divorce fell persistently from the mid-1990s in more exposed districts, by about 9 percent of the mean for a one-standard-deviation difference in exposure; the weak-instrument-robust confidence set excludes zero. Marriages did not rise, and wife- and husband-filed divorces did not respond differently. Event studies back to 1980 do not reject parallel pre-reunification trends, and more exposed districts did not experience faster income growth. The evidence is inconsistent with a thicker partner market and too large for a sex-ratio channel; it is consistent with higher costs of forming and dissolving households or with changes in resident composition.

WORKING PAPERS

Housing Security and Family Expansion: Evidence from German Homeownership. Estimates the effect of homeownership on fertility among West German women using SOEP-Core, with district and year fixed effects and parental homeownership as an instrument. Homeownership accelerates the transition from first to second birth, while the effect on the cumulative number of children is small and statistically insignificant, consistent with a tempo effect; effects on completed family size remain open. Estimates are local to women whose ownership depends on their parents' ownership; inference is robust to weak instruments.

Transition to Adulthood: Local Rents and Leaving the Parental Home. Links SOEP-Core residence histories to RWI-GEO-REDX quality-adjusted rent indices at the parental-home postal code to study young adults' first exit from the parental home, with heterogeneity by migration background. Across locations, higher rents predict earlier exit, consistent with high-rent areas being opportunity-rich. Within postal codes over time, the rent gradient turns weakly negative and imprecise; bounds rule out large affordability effects, and lead–lag placebo tests attribute part of the remaining gradient to local trends rather than rents.

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter) *Oct 2023–Sep 2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- DFG Research Training Group 2484, "Regional Disparities and Economic Policy."
- Course administration for Econometric Evaluation of Economic Policies; co-supervised BSc and MSc theses.

Research Intern *Jul 2022–Oct 2022*
Vienna University of Economics and Business, Institute for Cognition and Behavior

- Programmed an oTree bargaining experiment on overconfidence and motivated beliefs (MSc thesis data).

Student Research Assistant to Constantinos Hadjichristidis *Jan 2022–Aug 2022*
University of Trento, Department of Economics and Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor / Course Designer: Introductory Migration Economics *Winter Semester 2025/26*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Designed and taught an English-language bachelor seminar: migrant selection (Roy model), integration and human capital, Chiswick–Borjas earnings assimilation, empirical designs, labor-market effects.

PRESENTATIONS

ENHR Annual Conference (European Network for Housing Research), homeownership paper July 2025

DFG Research Training Group 2484, internal workshops 2024–2026

DATA AND SKILLS

Administrative	Court and vital statistics (OCR-digitized and validated, 1980–2007); district migration matrices; 1961 and 1987 census district files; regional accounts.
Survey	SOEP-Core with district and postal-code identifiers (secure access); RWI-GEO-REDX; INKAR.
Software	Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, oTree.
Languages	Turkish (Native), English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Italian (Elementary).

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Assistant Editor *Jan 2022–Oct 2023*
behavioraleconomics.com, remote (UK)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

University of Trento Merit Scholarship, 2021–2023;
Erasmus+ Mobility Grant, 2022–2023;
METU Alumni Association Merit Scholarship, 2016–2019;
Honor Roll, Middle East Technical University, 2016–2017.

REFERENCES

Thomas K. Bauer
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